

William O'Neill

Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) Leader

Atlanta, GA

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Summary

Staff Site Reliability Engineer with a track record of leading high-impact infrastructure initiatives across cloud platforms, observability, and reliability engineering. Known for driving cost-efficient architecture decisions, improving operational clarity, and enabling teams through automation, documentation, and scalable systems design.

Work Experience

Vantage

New York, NY (remote)

Staff Site Reliability Engineer

August 2025 - Current

- Defined and led the modernization strategy for stateful infrastructure, including a zero-downtime PostgreSQL 13 → 18 upgrade using blue/green deployment patterns, eliminating ~\$7K/month in extended support costs and establishing a repeatable upgrade model for future systems
- Improved production signal fidelity by aligning AWS ALB and application-layer error handling, reducing false-positive alerts and materially increasing on-call effectiveness across engineering teams
- Established observability standards that differentiate infrastructure and application failure modes, leveraging Datadog dashboards and alerting to accelerate incident response and improve system diagnosability
- Identified systemic gaps in Cloudflare AI Gateway logging and metering, restoring data integrity for customer-facing analytics and driving forward-compatible fixes across ingestion pipelines
- Influenced cost and vendor strategy through targeted improvements in observability usage efficiency and Datadog contract optimization
- Provided technical leadership across major platform initiatives, including ECS → EKS migration, Terraform standardization, and DNS/VPN reliability improvements, ensuring alignment with long-term scalability and operability goals
- Introduced and scaled the use of architecture decision records (ADRs) and operational runbooks, improving cross-team alignment, reducing ambiguity in production operations, and enabling more autonomous engineering execution
- Shaped operational best practices that reduced reliance on tribal knowledge, improved incident response consistency, and increased overall engineering velocity

SurveyMonkey

San Mateo, CA (remote)

Senior Engineering Manager - Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

August 2022 - May 2025

- Led a three-year transformation to a scalable Kubernetes-based infrastructure, replacing an overprovisioned static setup.
- Successfully migrated and refactored 200 Services, 30 ML models and 100 libraries & SDKs with zero downtime.
- Achieved a 40%+ reduction (~\$2M annual savings) in compute costs.
- Reduced secrets sprawl by streamlining Hashicorp Vault policies and ensuring that local development environments were configured to use the same policies.
- Led and mentored a high-performing team of six remote engineers, fostering collaboration and innovation.

Staff Software Engineer - Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

October 2021 - August 2022

- Designed and implemented automation frameworks, eliminating manual toil and boosting CI/CD efficiency.

ReCharge Payments

Santa Monica, CA (remote)

Senior DevOps Engineer

June 2020 - October 2021

- Implemented CI/CD pipelines for Terraform and Ansible, accelerating peer review cycle time by 60% (from 2-3 days to under 1 day).
- Created standardized Terraform stacks, enabling self-service infrastructure deployment.
- Designed an interactive candidate tech lab as an additional vetting process during the team's interview cycle.
- Improved individualized developer testing environments by implementing Let's Encrypt SSL certificates and OAuth based authorization.

Teachers Pay Teachers

New York, NY (remote)

DevOps Tech Lead

December 2018 - June 2020

- Coordinated transition from larger operations team to Cloud Operations focused infrastructure team.
- Drove improvements to processes so that requests from development teams were fulfilled in a consistent manner. These changes enabled the Cloud Operations team to implement SLOs for most common requests.
- Led PCI Level 1 certification efforts, reducing audit time from multiple weeks to just 2 days.
- Developed reusable Terraform modules that encapsulated best practices for AWS infrastructure automation.

Spreadly

Senior Systems Engineer

Durham, NC (remote)

May 2017 - November 2018

- Ensured Spreadly's PCI Level 1 card vault status by introducing security compliance tooling as part of the build and deployment process.
- Transitioned deployments from manual bespoke processes to immutable infrastructure-as-code via Ansible, Packer, and Terraform.
- Active contributor to the open source [DevSec Hardening Framework](#) project.

GE Digital

Lead Infrastructure Automation Engineer

Atlanta, GA

August 2016 - May 2017

- Improved automation of the wing to wing monitoring of GE's network and compute assets. Consolidated monitoring tool sprawl by creating business unit dashboards.
- Automated microservices lifecycle deployment using Jenkins, Sphinx, Swagger, and Ansible.
- Developed an easy button application for the first contact helpdesk which empowered them to do tasks such as pinging hosts, check on application status, and even reboot machines with supervisor approval.

MailChimp

Senior Infrastructure Engineer

Atlanta, GA

October 2012 - May 2016

- Spearheaded migration from 3rd-party managed hosting to self-managed colocation data centers.
- Scaled the operations team from 3 to 40 engineers while optimizing infrastructure performance via documentation of the greenfield datacenter implementations, tech talks on subjects such as Puppet development, infrastructure testing, and 1-on-1 mentorship.
- Migrated high traffic DNS domains from a provider that billed based on usage to Akamai. This reduced costs since billing was no longer traffic based and increased the SLA for DNS.
- Consolidated hundreds of domain names spread across several registrars to one registrar. This made management of domain names more consistent, provided visibility into domain names that should be added or dropped as necessary, and enabled creation of a customized 'parked page' for unused domains.
- Subject matter expert for DNS (internal and external), server provisioning and Akamai CDN configurations.
- Developed internal tooling that automatically provisioned servers from 'rack and stack' bare metal to a fully installed OS registered with an in-house CMDB. Same tooling was also used to handle kvm-based virtual provisioning.
- Implemented configuration management using Puppet, replacing an in-house configuration management tool where development had been abandoned.

Skills

Cloud & Infrastructure	Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform
CI/CD & DevOps	Helm, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD, Ansible, Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD
Programming	Python, Ruby, Node.js, Shell
Security & Compliance	PCI DSS, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), Cloud Security

Presentations

PAYMENTSfn 2018

Durham, NC

[Raising Children vs Raising Rabbits](#)

May 2018

- A lightning talk about the tooling behind Spreadly's cloud instances and how compliance and security are built into the process.

GitHub Octotales

[Octotales: MailChimp](#)

March 2016

- GitHub's video profile of MailChimp and their use of GitHub Enterprise. My favorite quote: "As an infrastructure guy, code is our poetry."

Atlanta Puppet Camp

Atlanta, GA

[Continuous Deployment of Puppet Modules](#)

December 2014

- Presentation about how MailChimp uses a combination of DSL tooling, editor plugins, peer review, and Jenkins to do continuous deployment of puppet modules to their infrastructure.

Education

Temple University

Philadelphia, PA

Bachelor of Arts, Mass Communication